

PROJECT: RefScout

STACK: vanilla JS/HTML/CSS currently

SCOPE: Rebuild the site's primary interface around a single unified file buffer (drop files here), replacing the current equal-weight tool-tabs navigation as the default landing experience. Make a solid frontend architecture and fully functional UX.

1. ENTRY POINT

- One drop-zone / file picker accepting PDF, .tex, .bib on the main page (plus optional copy-paste options for manual plain text entry (or tex/bib).
- When user commands, run Full Check's existing pipeline (PreSubmit + BibCheck + Glossary already wired) PLUS Cite (currently NOT part of Full Check - new integration work).

2. RESULTS: PER-MODULE BREAKDOWN, NOT ONE NUMBER

- Render one score card per module (e.g. BibCheck 70%, Glossary 30%, CiteCheck 60%, PreSubmit 45%) instead of a single aggregate score.
- Each card expands into that module's existing detailed results (reuse current per-tool result UI, don't rebuild it from scratch, optimization would be good).

3. CITE ACCESS ROLES

- Full/paid users: All options are active (except Alpha access)
- Free registered users: all free tools are unlimited, premium options - are not active (simple on/off for now)
- Free anonymous users: 20 usages/day of any free tool

Current modules:

Free (limited usage - 20/day per unregistered user):

BibCheck
Glossary
DiffChecker
Scout

Free and Require registration:

Library

Not free (after trial). Registration is required (AI tokens used):

PreSubmit
Cite
FullCheck
Verify (alpha, not available publicly yet)

4. OLD NAVIGATION

- The current tool tabs/pills stop being the primary way in — the drop-zone is now the default landing view.
- OPEN QUESTION, confirm with operator before starting: do the individual tool pages (scout.html, bibcheck.html, etc. — currently live SEO landing pages) stay as separate entry points feeding into the same unified result view, or get retired? Default assumption unless told otherwise: KEEP them as landing pages, but each should route into the same new unified flow rather than the old separate tab UI.

5. TECH CHOICE: DEVELOPER'S CALL

Current stack is vanilla JS + vibecoded. You are NOT required to stay vanilla JS for this piece, or keep any of the existing frontend code: if a framework (React/Vue/etc.) genuinely produces a better result for this specific rebuild, use it.

OUT OF SCOPE: Scout/BibCheck/PreSubmit/Glossary/DiffChecker/Library's internal logic (reuse as-is via existing APIs), Stripe/pricing, backend scoring logic changes beyond wiring Cite into Full Check's existing job model.

ACCEPTANCE: working drop-zone → per-module score cards → expandable detail, on a real PDF and a real .tex+.bib pair, demoed live or via screen recording. All main steps are implemented.

Milestones:

1. Suggested architecture with all the details (after internal discussions)
2. Visual design Mockup
3. Working prototype
4. Fully implemented frontend

Payments are done upon completion of each milestone (25% each).